

ROBINSON VIDVA

Biomedical Data Scientist

Washington, DC area

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SUMMARY

Biomedical data scientist with more than 16 years of experience in multi-omics analysis, machine learning, and data analytics pipelines for computational oncology, immuno-oncology, drug discovery, and pediatric neurodevelopment. Work integrates mutational, gene-expression, imaging, and clinical data to identify biomarkers of treatment response and to link molecular pathways to clinical and behavioral outcomes. Independent and idea-driven: founded and ran a computational biology consultancy; co-inventor on three granted patents and three published patent applications; built five open-source tools, including a laboratory platform in use at three laboratories; led teams of 10 or more scientists while setting the organization's standards for model validation. Works with large language models (LLMs) and agentic coding tools as a routine part of analysis, software development, and quality control of research outputs. Record: 7 peer-reviewed papers, 2 preprints, 14 conference abstracts, 3 granted patents and 3 published applications, 150+ citations, 5 open-source tools.

RESEARCH FOCUS

Computational oncology and precision medicine: cancer genomics and NGS analysis; biomarkers of treatment response; patient-specific drug-response models and digital twins; drug repurposing and combination therapy design; hematologic malignancies, especially AML; cancer immunology.

Immunology and inflammatory disease: systems-biology models of macrophage, dendritic-cell, and T-cell signaling; mucosal and innate immunity; immune-modulating therapeutics; rheumatoid arthritis and inflammatory bowel disease.

Pediatric and neonatal translational research: multi-domain clinical data (MRI, ultrasound, growth, neurodevelopmental assessments); preterm brain injury and cerebellar development; neonatal hypoxic-ischemic injury; necrotizing enterocolitis; sudden infant death syndrome; behavioral phenotyping and early rehabilitation.

Open-source and AI-enabled research infrastructure: reproducible, LLM-assisted analysis and quality control workflows; laboratory management platforms (MyVivarium); browser-based tools for enrichment analysis, drug-target exploration, drug interactions, and pose kinematics.

EDUCATION

M.S., Data Analytics, Western Governors University, Salt Lake City, UT

07/2024 - 01/2025

Capstone: Regression and clustering analysis of Seoul bike-sharing demand.

M.B.A., Project Management, Sikkim Manipal University (Distance Education), Gangtok, India

11/2012 - 02/2020

Project: A study on the importance of HRM in project management at Pathfinder Global Solutions.

B.Tech. (Bachelor of Technology), Biotechnology, Bharathidasan University, Tiruchirappalli, India
07/2003 - 04/2007

First Class with Distinction. Project: Biochemical and microbiological analysis of dairy milk plant effluent.

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Technician (Bioinformatics)

Children's National Hospital, Washington, DC | 03/2025 - Present

- Kratimenos Lab, Sheikh Zayed Institute for Pediatric Surgical Innovation. Curate and quality-control multi-source clinical data sets for two preterm-infant cohort studies, integrating electronic health records, imaging, laboratory, metabolomic, and transcriptomic data into de-identified source-of-truth datasets for one study on cerebellar development after preterm birth (178 infants) and one on necrotizing enterocolitis and brain injury (181 infants).
- Perform statistical analyses relating clinical exposures to brain development in those cohorts using linear, mixed-effects, segmented, logistic, and modified Poisson models to evaluate cerebellar growth, MRI findings, and neurodevelopmental outcomes, with stratification and sensitivity analyses.
- Build and maintain reproducible RNA-seq pipelines for mouse and human cerebellar studies of prematurity insults, necrotizing enterocolitis, and sudden infant death syndrome; perform differential expression, pathway, and GO enrichment analyses with visualization.
- Quantify rodent behavior with DeepLabCut and B-SOiD in a mouse model of prematurity insults (maternal immune activation and neonatal hypoxia) and its early-rehabilitation extension; develop statistical and machine-learning models on Erasmus Ladder motor-coordination data from 160 preterm mice.
- Write reproducible figure and table code, verify final manuscripts against deposited data, prepare public-repository submissions of sequencing data, support manuscript preparation and revision, and contribute the cancer-immunology content and figures to a co-authored review on immune modulation in skin cancer (Frontiers in Immunology, 2025).

Career Break and Professional Development

07/2022 - 02/2025 | Bayonne, NJ

- Relocated from India to the United States for family reasons; completed an accelerated M.S. in Data Analytics (WGU, 2025) and advanced immunology certifications (Imperial College London, 2023).
- Expanded software engineering skills into full-stack web development, Linux server administration, and cloud deployment, later used to build the open-source tools.

Founder and Lead Computational Biologist

Digirobi Solutions, Bengaluru, India | 09/2019 - 06/2022

- Founded and led an independent computational biology consultancy, delivering commercial and academic engagements in cancer therapeutics and research software.
- Built cancer genomics, drug, and nutrition databases from public and proprietary sources for a nutrigenomics platform, and co-invented the resulting nutraceutical combination therapy for cancer, granted in the United States and Europe.
- Built a mechanistic model of Src kinase signaling in neonatal hypoxic neuronal injury (MATLAB SimBiology, sensitivity analysis), which resulted in a peer-reviewed paper (2022).
- Designed and built MyVivarium, an open-source colony-management platform with IoT sensing, now used in three laboratories, and led its publication (2025).

Senior Lead Scientist

Cellworks Life, Bengaluru, India | 11/2017 - 09/2019

- Led a team of more than 10 scientists developing computational precision-medicine platforms for oncology, and set the standards for model reproducibility and validation.
- Using TCGA, MSK-IMPACT, and proprietary genomic, transcriptomic, and pharmacological data, designed and validated patient-specific drug-response models across solid and hematologic cancers. In the Beat AML study, predicted BET-inhibitor response matched ex vivo IC50 results for 93 percent of 100 acute myeloid leukemia (AML) patients (sensitivity 97.7 percent; Leukemia Research, 2019), and multi-cell biomarker models matched observed cytokine profiles in 75 to 80 percent of cases (Scientific Reports, 2019).
- Built the cell line resource (more than 500 lines with IC50 profiles) and the curated clinical data collections (more than 15) used to train, validate, and benchmark the models.

Lead Scientist

Cellworks Life, Bengaluru, India | 01/2014 - 10/2017

- Built a knowledge base of about 200 compounds covering targets, mechanisms, pharmacokinetics, and resistance, then turned each into a simulatable drug model within the disease platform.
- Co-invented the PTEN/TP53-targeted cancer combination therapy (US 10,098,880 B2), drafting the claims and handling prosecution through examiner objections.
- Delivered more than 25 training sessions on topics related to computational biology, immunology, and data analytics, evaluated therapeutic candidates with pharmaceutical partners, and mentored junior scientists.

Associate Lead Scientist

Cellworks Life, Bengaluru, India | 06/2008 - 12/2013

- Built and validated an eight-cell-type systems biology model of rheumatoid arthritis against in vivo data, identified two synergistic repurposed drug combinations, and showed one reduced disease progression in a murine collagen-induced arthritis model.
- Contributed to peer-reviewed work on inflammatory skin and oral mucosal disease with collaborators, and to two patent applications and American College of Rheumatology presentations.
- Established the company's quality standards for model development and validation.

Associate Biomodeling Scientist

Cellworks Life, Bengaluru, India | 07/2007 - 05/2008

- Built mechanistic models of immune signaling in macrophages spanning more than 20 pathways and gene-regulatory networks, and designed the perturbation-based validation approach adopted across the modeling platform.

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed original research

1. **Vidva R**, Raza MA, Prabhakaran J, Sheikh A, Sharp A, Ott H, et al. MyVivarium: a cloud-based lab animal colony management application with real-time ambient sensing. *Comput Struct Biotechnol J*. 2025;27:612-23. [doi:10.1016/j.csbj.2025.01.025](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.csbj.2025.01.025)
2. Kratimenos P, Vij A, **Vidva R**, Koutroulis I, Delivoria-Papadopoulos M, Gallo V, et al. Computational analysis of cortical neuronal excitotoxicity in a large animal model of neonatal brain injury. *J Neurodev Disord*. 2022;14(1):26. [doi:10.1186/s11689-022-09431-3](https://doi.org/10.1186/s11689-022-09431-3)

3. Fischer CL, Bates AM, Lanzel EA, Guthmiller JM, Johnson GK, Singh NK, Kumar A, **Vidva R**, et al. Computational models accurately predict multi-cell biomarker profiles in inflammation and cancer. *Sci Rep*. 2019;9(1):10877. [doi:10.1038/s41598-019-47381-4](https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-019-47381-4)
4. Drusbosky LM, **Vidva R**, Gera S, Lakshminarayana AV, Shyamasundar VP, Agrawal AK, et al. Predicting response to BET inhibitors using computational modeling: a BEAT AML project study. *Leuk Res*. 2019;77:42-50. [doi:10.1016/j.leukres.2018.11.010](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.leukres.2018.11.010)
5. Borgwardt DS, Martin AD, Van Hemert JR, Yang J, Fischer CL, Recker EN, Nair PR, **Vidva R**, et al. Histatin 5 binds to *Porphyromonas gingivalis* hemagglutinin B (HagB) and alters HagB-induced chemokine responses. *Sci Rep*. 2014;4:3904. [doi:10.1038/srep03904](https://doi.org/10.1038/srep03904)
6. Harvey LE, Kohlgraf KG, Mehalick LA, Raina M, Recker EN, Radhakrishnan S, Prasad SA, **Vidva R**, et al. Defensin DEFB103 bidirectionally regulates chemokine and cytokine responses to a pro-inflammatory stimulus. *Sci Rep*. 2013;3:1232. [doi:10.1038/srep01232](https://doi.org/10.1038/srep01232)

Review articles

1. Giannopoulos K, Karikis I, Byrd C, Sanidas G, Wolff N, Triantafyllou M, Simonti G, **Vidva R**, et al. Eph/Ephrin-mediated immune modulation: a potential therapeutic target for skin cancer. *Front Immunol*. 2025;16:1539567. [doi:10.3389/fimmu.2025.1539567](https://doi.org/10.3389/fimmu.2025.1539567)

Preprints

1. Sanidas G, Simonti G, Ghaemmaghani J, Woyshner K, **Vidva R**, Bittel D, et al. Prematurity insults remodel cerebellar development and behavior. *bioRxiv* [Preprint]. 2025; revised 2026 Sep 9. [doi:10.1101/2025.07.22.664624](https://doi.org/10.1101/2025.07.22.664624)
2. Sanidas G, Simonti G, Ghaemmaghani J, Woyshner K, Polyviou A, **Vidva R**, et al. Intrinsic gestational timing governs human cerebellar development after preterm birth. *bioRxiv* [Preprint]. 2025; revised 2026 Sep 7. [doi:10.1101/2025.09.01.673244](https://doi.org/10.1101/2025.09.01.673244)

RESEARCH SOFTWARE

1. **MyVivarium, lead author and maintainer** | 2021 - present. Built cloud platform for lab-animal colony management with QR cage cards and IoT environmental sensing using PHP, MySQL, JavaScript, IoT sensors; v2 with Docker and Playwright tests; in use at three laboratories (200+ animals); v2 in deployment. github.com/myvivarium/MyVivarium; *Comput Struct Biotechnol J*. 2025;27:612-23. [doi:10.1016/j.csbj.2025.01.025](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.csbj.2025.01.025).
2. **enrichlite, sole author** | 2026. Built in-browser gene-set over-representation analysis (GO, Hallmark, Reactome) for human and mouse using JavaScript, client-side only; public tool. robinsonvidva.com/enrichlite.
3. **drugtargets, sole author** | 2026. Built drug-target exploration and repurposing tool on Open Targets and openFDA using TypeScript; public tool. drugtargets.robinsonvidva.com.
4. **DrugInteract, sole author** | 2026. Built client-side FDA drug-interaction reference on openFDA and RxNorm using JavaScript, client-side only; public tool. robinsonvidva.com/DrugInteract.
5. **neokine, sole author** | 2026. Built client-side MediaPipe pose visualization with joint-angle, velocity, and asymmetry plots using JavaScript, MediaPipe; public tool. robinsonvidva.com/neokine.

PATENTS AND PUBLISHED PATENT APPLICATIONS

Granted

1. Vali S, Abbasi T, Stopka T, Minarik L, Singh NK, Usmani S, Radhakrishnan S, Sikora H, **Vidva R**, et al. Combination therapy comprising plant derived compounds and antineoplastic compounds for treatment of hematological malignancies. European Patent EP 3,861,992 B1, granted 2023 Sep 6 (Cannafamily AS). European counterpart of US 11,478,444 B2.
2. Vali S, Abbasi T, Stopka T, Minarik L, Singh NK, Usmani S, Radhakrishnan S, Sikora H, **Vidva R**, et al. Use of scientifically matched plant supplements combined with antineoplastic compounds for the treatment of hematological malignancies. US Patent 11,478,444 B2, granted 2022 Oct 25 (Brio Ventures LLC).
3. Vali S, Usmani S, Sultana Z, Kumar A, Abbasi T, **Vidva R**. Combination of nelfinavir, metformin and rosuvastatin for treating cancer caused by aberrations in PTEN/TP53. US Patent 10,098,880 B2, granted 2018 Oct 16 (Cell Works Group Inc.).

Published applications

4. Vali S, Abbasi T, Fernandes P, Rajagopalan S, Alam A, **Vidva R**, et al. System and method for development of therapeutic solutions. US Patent Application 2015/0302167 A1, published 2015 Oct 22 (Cell Works Group Inc.).
5. Vali S, **Vidva R**, Nair PR, Fernandes P, Abbasi T, Radhakrishnan S. Compositions, process of preparation of said compositions and method of treating inflammatory diseases. US Patent Application 2015/0098993 A1, published 2015 Apr 9 (Cell Works Group Inc.).
6. Vali S, **Vidva R**, Nair PR, Fernandes P, Abbasi T, Radhakrishnan S. Compositions, process of preparation of said compositions and method of treating inflammatory diseases. US Patent Application 2014/0127295 A1, published 2014 May 8 (Cellworks Research India Pvt Ltd; Cell Works Group Inc.).

CONFERENCE ABSTRACTS

1. Sanidas G, Lowe C, Byrd C, **Vidva R**, Simonti G, Chandereng T, et al. Necrotizing enterocolitis selectively disrupts pontine development in the preterm brain. Poster PSTR103.21. Society for Neuroscience Annual Meeting; 2025 Nov 16; San Diego, CA. [\[Abstract\]](#)
2. Simonti G, **Vidva R**, Sanidas G, Byrd C, Lowe C, Triantafyllou M, et al. Early postnatal rehabilitation mitigates motor, growth, and social deficits in perinatal brain injury. Poster PSTR019.10. Society for Neuroscience Annual Meeting; 2025 Nov 15; San Diego, CA. [\[Abstract\]](#)
3. Cogle CR, Abbasi T, Singh NK, Sauban M, Raman RK, **Vidva R**, et al. AraC-daunorubicin-etoposide (ADE) response prediction in pediatric AML patients using a computational biology modeling (CBM) based precision medicine workflow. Blood. 2018;132(Suppl 1):4034. [doi:10.1182/blood-2018-99-115775](https://doi.org/10.1182/blood-2018-99-115775)
4. Tyner JW, Druker BJ, Tognon CE, Kurtz SE, Drusbosky LM, Sahu D, **Vidva R**, et al. Predicting response to dasatinib using a computational model and its validation: a Beat AML project study. Blood. 2018;132(Suppl 1):1541. [doi:10.1182/blood-2018-99-115678](https://doi.org/10.1182/blood-2018-99-115678)
5. Tyner JW, Druker BJ, Kurtz SE, Tognon CE, Drusbosky LM, **Vidva R**, et al. Predicting response to BET inhibitor in combination with palbociclib/sorafenib using a computational model: a Beat AML project study. Blood. 2018;132(Suppl 1):1540. [doi:10.1182/blood-2018-99-115284](https://doi.org/10.1182/blood-2018-99-115284)

6. Drusbosky LM, Turcotte M, Castillo P, **Vidva R**, et al. Predicting response to CDK4/6 inhibitors and combinations using a computational biology model: a Beat AML project study. *Blood*. 2017;130(Suppl 1):3909. [\[Abstract\]](#)
7. Drusbosky LM, **Vidva R**, et al. Predicting response to BET inhibitors using a computational model and its validation: a Beat AML project study. *Blood*. 2017;130(Suppl 1):3908. [\[Abstract\]](#)
8. Drusbosky LM, **Vidva R**, et al. Predicting response to IDH1/IDH2 inhibitors beyond IDH mutations using a computational model: a Beat AML project study. *Blood*. 2017;130(Suppl 1):3907. [\[Abstract\]](#)
9. Drusbosky L, Abbasi T, Vali S, Radhakrishnan S, Singh NK, Usmani S, Parashar D, **Vidva R**, et al. A genomic signature predicting venetoclax treatment response in AML. *Blood*. 2016;128(22):1713. [doi:10.1182/blood.V128.22.1713.1713](#)
10. Fischer C, Abbasi T, Vali S, Nair P, **Vidva R**, Tiwari K, et al. A predictive model of an oral inflammatory response. *J Dent Res*. 2014;93(Spec Iss A):1369. [\[Abstract\]](#)
11. Harvey L, Recker E, Raina M, Radhakrishnan S, Prasad S, **Vidva R**, et al. HBD3 both enhances and attenuates dendritic cell MAPK responses to HagB. *J Dent Res*. 2013;92(Spec Iss A):2820. [\[Abstract\]](#)
12. Singh G, **Vidva R**, Nair P, Radhakrishnan S, Fernandes P, Abbasi T, et al. Predictive software-based mathematical modeling: a novel approach to development of oral therapies for rheumatoid arthritis, validation in a murine collagen induced arthritis model. *Arthritis Rheum*. 2012;64(10 Suppl):S149-50. [doi:10.1002/art.37735](#) [\[Abstract\]](#)
13. Vali S, Refino C, Cruz JD, **Vidva R**, Nair P, Radhakrishnan S, et al. Novel combination therapy of existing repurposed therapies designed by predictive software modeling shows profound impact on disease progression in a murine collagen induced arthritis model. *Arthritis Rheum*. 2012;64(10 Suppl):S148. [doi:10.1002/art.37735](#) [\[Abstract\]](#)
14. Vali S, Hegedus C, Bhattacharjee C, **Vidva R**, Schmelzer K, Inceoglu B, et al. Insights into the anti-inflammatory action of the soluble epoxide hydrolase inhibitor through a systems biology based in silico modeling approach. *FASEB J*. 2008;22(1 Suppl):479.13. [doi:10.1096/fasebj.22.1_supplement.479.13](#)

TEACHING AND MENTORING

- Mentored more than 25 junior scientists and engineers at Cellworks Life and Digirobi Solutions, 2014 - 2022.
- Designed and delivered more than 25 internal training sessions on computational biology, data analytics, and modeling methods, 2014 - 2019.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Membership: International Society for Computational Biology (ISCB), 2024 - present

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, R, SQL, MATLAB, C/C++, Unix shell, JavaScript/TypeScript, HTML/CSS, PHP

Bioinformatics and multi-omics: bulk RNA-seq, metabolomics, genomics; next-generation sequencing (NGS) DNA and RNA analysis; variant analysis (SNV, CNV); pathway and cell-cell communication analysis; gene-set enrichment; integration of clinical datasets (MRI, ultrasound, neurodevelopmental scores)

Modeling and machine learning: mechanistic network models, ODE and stochastic pathway models, systems biology; scikit-learn, TensorFlow, Keras, PyTorch; generalized linear models, mixed-effects models, survival analysis

Behavioral phenotyping: DeepLabCut, B-SOiD, BONSAI, OpenCV, MediaPipe; three-chamber sociability and Erasmus Ladder analysis; motor and gait phenotyping

Software engineering and infrastructure: full-stack web development; Git, GitHub, Jira; CI/CD; Snakemake; Docker and Singularity; database design; Linux server administration; LSF job scheduling; AWS; IoT integration for laboratory environments

AI-assisted research: large language models (LLMs) and agentic coding tools (Claude and similar) for analysis code, literature synthesis, and reproducibility checks; prompt and workflow design; validation of model output against source data

Visualization: Tableau, matplotlib, seaborn, ggplot2; scientific reporting and dashboards

Clinical data and compliance: clinical and electronic health record (EHR) data, de-identified, under approved IRB protocols; HIPAA and PHI handling; data-use agreements

Languages: English (fluent), Tamil (native)

CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- Advanced Data Modeling, Data Analytics Fundamentals, and Data Preparation, Western Governors University, 2024 - 2025
- Immunology series: Innate Immune System, Adaptive Immune System, and Immune Failures and Cancer Immunology, Imperial College London (Coursera), 2023
- Fundamentals of Immunology: Complement, MHC I and II, T Cells, and Cytokines (2021) and Innate Immunity and B-Cell Function (2020), Rice University (Coursera)
- Basic Principles of Cell Signaling, KAIST (Coursera), 2021
- Traditional Herbal Medicine in Supportive Cancer Care, Technion (Coursera), 2020
- Demystifying Biomedical Big Data: A User's Guide, Georgetown University (edX), 2020
- Design and Interpretation of Clinical Trials, Johns Hopkins University (Coursera), 2019
- Cancer Biology Specialization, Johns Hopkins University (Coursera), 2018
- Drug Development Product Management Specialization, University of California San Diego (Coursera), 2017
- Genomic and Precision Medicine, and Ethical and Social Challenges of Genomic and Precision Medicine, University of California San Francisco (Coursera), 2017
- DL-101 General Course on Intellectual Property and DL-204 Biotechnology and Intellectual Property, World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO), 2012

REFERENCES

Available on request.